MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (HONOURS)
FIRST SEMESTER EXAMINATION (2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)
MG1MDCPSY101 - PSYCHOLOGY OF SPORTS AND EXERCISE
Part A
One Mark Questions
Answer 10 questions
Each question carries 1 mark

Sl. No	Question	Answer
1	What are the two main components of motivation? [K] [1]	Direction and intensity of one's effort.
2	What is meant by "intensity of effort" in the context of motivation? [K] [1]	Intensity of effort refers to how much effort a person puts forth in a particular situation
3	What is sports fandom? [K] [2]	Sports fandom refers to the enthusiastic and often passionate support of a sports team, athlete, or the sport itself by individuals known as fans.
4	Who are the key proponents of Achievement Goal Theory?[K] [1]	Carole Ames, John Nicholls , Carol Dweck
5	Which is the most stable level of personality? [K] [1]	Psychological Core
6	What type of motivation is driven by rewards and recognition? [U] [2]	Extrinsic motivation
7	Who proposed the theory that personality could be described by two traits: extraversion and neuroticism? [K] [3]	Eysenck
8	What are the different exercises for improving concentration? [K] [1]	Learning to shift attention,learning to maintain focus, searching for relevant cues, rehearsing game concentration
9	What is ironic effect? [K] [2]	It refers to the phenomenon where efforts to suppress certain thoughts and behaviors.
10	What hypothesis explains the interaction between task demands and an athlete's resources? [K] [2]	Resource matching hypothesis

Part B
Multiple Choice Questions
Answer 10 questions.
Each question carries 1 marks.

11. What does "direction of effort" refer to? [K] [1]
Answer: b) The approach towards certain situations
12. What is the focus of positive self-talk? [K] [1]
Answer: b) Boosting confidence
13. What does the Resource-Matching Hypothesis primarily suggest about emotions in sports? . [K]
Answer : b) Emotional responses depend on the balance between task demands and an athlete's resources.
14. Who is known as the father of sports psychology?
Answer :d) Coleman Griffith.
15. The social facilitation theory suggests that an audience improves performance on:
Answer: b) Well-learned tasks

16. Which system is responsible for transporting oxygen and nutrients in the body? [U] [1, 2]

Answer: b) Cardiovascular System

17. What type of motivation is driven by personal satisfaction and love for the sport? [1, 2] U]

Answer: a) Intrinsic Motivation

18. According to Eysenck, what trait describes someone who is lively and sociable? [U] [4]

Answer: c) Extraversion**.**

19. Which of the following is NOT one of the five factors in Costa & McCrae's model? [U] [1, 3, 4]

Answer: c) Stability.

20. The first experiment in sports psychology was conducted by

Answer: c) Norman Triplett.

Part C: Short Answer Questions

Answer any 8 questions.

Each question carries 2 marks.

21. Imagine yourself as a sports psychologist & elaborate that how can you train athletes to switch between different types of attentional focus depending on the demands of their sport. [C] [2]

Answer: Awareness Training: Educate athletes on different types of focus (broad, narrow, internal, external) and their uses. Simulated Drills: Design drills that mimic real-game scenarios requiring focus shifts "Cue Words and Self-Talk: Teach athletes to use specific cue words to trigger quick focus shifts Mindfulness and Visualization: Use mindfulness exercises and visualization techniques to practice focus control.Pressure Simulation: Implement high-pressure drills to prepare athletes for focus shifts under competitive stress.

22. Describe some of the pressures or risks associated with intense sports fandom. [U] [2]

Answer: Extreme sports fandom can lead fans to experience pressures such as the need for their team to succeed, addiction to sports gambling, or financial strain from spending on tickets and merchandise. These pressures can negatively impact personal finances and mental health. Emotional attachment, parasocial relationship with the sportspersons, fandom related violence can cause problems for fans of different kinds including families and young individuals.

23. Describe the cognitive-behavioral orientation in sport psychology. [U] [1,2]

Answer: Psychologists assume that behaviour is determined both by the environment and cognition)-how a person interprets the environment. They emphasize the athlete's or exerciser's cognitions, believing thought to be central in determining behavior. Cognitive-behavioral psychologists, might, for instance, develop self-report measures to assess self-confidence, anxiety, goal orientations, imagery, and intrinsic motivation. Then they would see how these assessments are linked to changes in an athlete's or exerciser's behavior.

24. What are the key benefits of positive psychology in sports? [U] [1,3]

Answer: Positive psychology in sports emphasizes developing optimism, resilience, and self-esteem in athletes. By focusing on positive traits rather than deficits, athletes build mental strength and a proactive mindset. Techniques like gratitude exercises, help maintain motivation, reduce stress, and foster a growth mindset. This approach enhances overall well-being, improves relationships with teammates, and prepares athletes to face challenges constructively, leading to a healthier and more sustainable sports experience.

25. What is Sports and Exercise psychology [K] [1,3]

Answer: Sport and exercise psychology is the scientific study of people and their behavior in sport and exercise contexts. Most study in sport and exercise psychology aims at two objectives: (a) learning how psychological factors affect an individual's physical performance (b) understanding how participation in sport and exercise affects a person's psychological development, health, and well-being.

26. Explain the strengths and Limitations of Scientifically Derived Knowledge and Professional Practice Knowledge [K] [1,3]

Answer: Scientifically derived Strength- Highly reliable, Systemic and controlled, Objective and unbiased.Limitations- Reductionistic, conservative—often slow to evolve Lack of focus on external validity (practicality).Professional practice -Strength - Holistic Innovative Immediate Limitations- Less reliable Lack of explanations Greater susceptibility to bias

27. Explain the effects of intrinsic and extrinsic motivation on athlete performance. [U] [1,2]
Answer: Intrinsic motivation arises from internal factors, such as a love for the game or personal satisfaction, and often results in greater persistence, creativity, and resilience, sustaining long-term engagement. In contrast, extrinsic motivation is driven by external rewards or recognition, which can be powerful but may not sustain performance in the long term. Relying only on extrinsic factors may lead to burnout or a decline in motivation if those rewards are absent.

28. Explain the importance of stress and anxiety management techniques for athletes. Provide examples. [U] [1,2]

Answer: Managing stress and anxiety is crucial for athletes as excessive levels can impair focus, reduce motor skills, and cause physical symptoms like tremors. Effective management techniques, such as breathing exercises, visualization, and mindfulness, help athletes maintain composure and focus under pressure. For example, athletes may practice deep breathing to reduce anxiety before competitions or use visualization to mentally rehearse successful performances, enhancing their sense of control and reducing pre-game nervousness.

29. Describe Eysenck's theory of personality and its relevance in sport psychology. [U] [3,4]

Answer: Extraversion measures how sociable, lively, and impulsive a person is, while neuroticism assesses emotional stability. Psychoticism, which measures toughness or tender-mindedness. This theory helps to understand how these traits influence athletes' behavior, their choice of sport, and their performance. For example, athletes scoring high on extraversion are often drawn to team sports, which involve high social interaction and stimulation.

30. Explain the interactional approach to personality in sport and provide an example of its application. [U] [1,4]

Answer: The interactional approach to behavior studies focuses on the interaction between situation and person as the codeterminants of behavior. It emphasizes understanding an individual's psychological traits and the specific situation to better understand behavior. Fisher and Zwart found that reactions were influenced by their mental and emotional state.

31. Discuss the role of focus enhancing techniques in sports psychology. [U] [2]

Answer: Focus on relevant environmental cues, maintain attentional focus, recognize internal and external distracters, use self talk, practice simulations, cue words, non judgemntal thinking, routines, learn to shift focus, maintain focus, distraction training. Focus-enhancing techniques in sports psychology are essential for optimizing athletic performance. A personalized approach that considers individual needs and preferences is crucial for the effective implementation of these strategies, leading to enhanced focus and overall performance in sports.

32. What are the strategies that we can use to manage fan behaviour ? [K] [3]

Answer: Managing fan behavior requires a proactive and multi-faceted approach that emphasizes education, clear communication, and community involvement. By implementing these strategies, sports organizations can create a safer, more enjoyable atmosphere for all attendees, ultimately fostering a positive sporting culture.

33. How does the interactional approach provide a more comprehensive understanding of athletic performance compared to the trait or situational approaches alone? [U] [3, 4]

Answer: The interactional approach integrates both personality traits and situational factors, suggesting that behavior is a product of the interaction between the two. Unlike the trait approach, which views behavior as stable across contexts, or the situational approach, which attributes behavior solely to the environment, the interactional approach recognizes that traits and situations influence each other.

Part D:Long Answer Type Questions

Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 7 marks.

34. Outline the effectiveness of using behavior modification techniques to change undesirable participant motives [U] [1]

Explain about sports psychology and motivation. Explain the guidelines to build motivation. Explain the fifth guideline. Coaches or leaders often have more control over the environment than participants' motives. However, in some cases, it may be necessary to change undesirable participant motives.Example of Behavior Modification: A young football player motivated to harm others. Actions by the Coach: Reinforce good, clean play. Punish aggressive play designed to inflict injury. Discuss appropriate and desirable behavior with the player. Alter undesirable motives. Strengthen weak motivation. Useful in sports, exercise programs, and rehabilitation contexts.

35. Evaluate the impact of goal orientations on an athlete's mental well-being, including the relationship between goal orientation and anxiety, stress, and resilience. [E] [4]

Explain about achievement goal theory and goal orientations. Explain the task and ego goal orinetations. Task-oriented athletes focus on personal growth, mastery, and improvement, which contributes positively to their mental well-being. This orientation reduces anxiety and stress as self-worth is based on internal benchmarks rather than external comparisons. Ego-oriented athletes tend to prioritize outperforming others, making their sense of self-worth heavily dependent on external validation. This creates higher levels of anxiety and stress, especially when their perceived abilities fall short of expectations. In such cases, they may display maladaptive behaviors, such as withdrawing from activities or resorting to deceptive tactics, which undermines resilience and their ability to handle setbacks.

36. Analyze how typical responses to situational pressures can vary among athletes. Provide examples of how these responses can influence performance in a competitive environment. [An] [1]

Athletes respond to situational pressures in varying ways, depending on factors like their personality, past experiences, and coping strategies. Some athletes see pressure as a challenge, responding with heightened focus and motivation, which can enhance their performance. For example, an experienced basketball player might use the energy from a cheering crowd to sharpen their attention during a critical free throw. Conversely, other athletes may perceive pressure as a threat, resulting in anxiety, distractions, or even avoidance behaviors, such as "choking" during key moments, as seen in athletes prone to high precompetitive anxiety. These responses significantly impact performance. Positive responses, like mental preparation and visualization, often enable athletes to adapt and excel in demanding situations, such as scoring the winning goal in overtime. On the other hand, negative responses, like focusing on the fear of failure, can hinder performance, as seen when a gymnast struggles to complete a routine due to self-doubt. Understanding and training athletes to manage these pressures effectively can optimize performance and enjoyment in competitive environments.

37. Discuss the importance of Conscientiousness in athletes and how it affects their training and competition. [U] [2]

Define Personality, traits and Big Five Personality theory. Mention five traits. Conscientiousness is a crucial personality trait for athletes, as it encompasses attributes like self-discipline, achievement striving, and the ability to plan and execute strategies. In training, conscientious athletes are more likely to set long-term goals, stick to their routines, and consistently refine their skills. This trait promotes the commitment needed to handle demanding schedules, work through physical fatigue, and maintain motivation during both highs and lows of the sport. In competitive environments, conscientiousness allows athletes to manage distractions, stick to their mental strategies, and focus on the process rather than just the outcome. This leads to improved performance and the ability to cope with setbacks, making conscientious athletes more resilient and persistent in their pursuits.Athletes with high conscientiousness tend to maintain a disciplined approach to their mental and physical conditioning, which contributes to their ability to remain composed during challenging moments. The ability to maintain focus and regulation under stress, along with a meticulous approach to training, enhances an athlete's overall performance and mental toughness. It plays a pivotal role in sustaining long-term success, as it fosters the qualities of dedication and attention to detail that are necessary in both practice and competition